quo for the Pakistani announcement that it was not going to renew the American lease for the air base near Peshawar. A few weeks after Kosygin's visit, Soviet navy vessels visited Pakistan. Then a few months later, in early July, a senior Pakistani military delegation traveled to Moscow to negotiate a defense deal, which Delhi learned was subsequently completed.[181]

The prime minister's office felt the Soviet approach was making Pakistan more intransigent. A letter drafted for Gandhi to send to Kosygin pointedly highlighted recent hostile statements from the Pakistani president and the foreign minister. It also expressed concern that the Soviet premier was trusting Pakistan's—rather than India's—assessments of India-Pakistan dynamics. It suggested that Moscow use its "growing influence" with Pakistan to encourage the Pakistanis to talk directly to India, implying that mediation would not be welcome.[182]

Internally, Haksar expressed a more serious Indian concern stemming from the "erroneous and misguided" Soviet decision—it raised questions about Soviet reliability more broadly and thus had implications for India-Soviet relations. Furthermore, it strengthened domestic critics of the India-Soviet relationship and of nonalignment.[183] Moscow's explanation—which sounded a lot like Washington's past ones—that improving relations with Islamabad allowed Moscow to undercut Sino-Pakistan ties, was not very reassuring. Gandhi was unhappy enough that she reportedly considered asking Moscow to cease military supply to both India and Pakistan. Defense ministry officials would scotch this idea. Continuing Soviet pressure to talk to Pakistan about Kashmir, however, only increased the Indian unhappiness about "diluted" support from Moscow.[184]

Gandhi stated publicly that the Soviet plan was "fraught with danger." Given the American experience with Pakistan, she doubted that any Soviet assurances about restrictions on the use of the supplied weapons would help.[185] In parliament, Gandhi acknowledged that she shared the country's "unease and anxiety," which had people protesting against the Soviet Union in the streets. She said that Soviet supply to Pakistan would add to regional instability and increase India's defense burden.[186] An American correspondent commented that the development had clearly shaken up the leadership and "Indians were probably doing more rethinking last week of their place in the world than at any time" since the 1962 war.[187]